

# CASSINI-HUYGENS

*Orbiter and lander*

The main radio dish on the Cassini probe is 4 m (13 ft) across

Cassini-Huygens was the first mission to orbit Saturn. Orbiter Cassini carried the small lander Huygens, which parachuted down through the clouds of the planet's biggest moon Titan and landed on its frozen plains. Cassini has taken close-up images of Saturn, its rings, and many of its icy moons.

The Cassini orbiter **took six-and-a-half years to reach Saturn.**

## DATA FILE



**SIZE:** 6.8 m (22 ft) long



**DATE LAUNCH:** 15 October 1997



**MISSION DURATION:** Ongoing



**SPACE AGENCIES:** NASA and ESA



Cassini's view of Saturn